

Board: 2

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 9 5 4
 ♥ 10 7 5 3
 ♦ J 10 3
 ♣ 8 5

♠ A J 7

♥ Q 8 6 4

♦ A Q 6

♣ A 10 3



♠ Q 8 2

♥ 9

♦ K 9 7 4

♣ K Q J 9 2

♠ K 6 3

♥ A K J 2

♦ 8 5 2

♣ 7 6 4

Holding a 4-card ♥ suit some bidders would use Stayman. However, when you have 4-3-3-3 distribution there is little chance of ruffing so others prefer not to use Stayman. You take the latter view and bid 3NT with your 11 points.

The contract would be 3NT played by South.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♣K and West follows with the ♣5.

Do you hold up? If so, how many times?

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

both cases the finesse would be into the East hand so the question of disrupting opponent's communications doesn't arise - West is not going to get the lead.

Winner List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 4 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 8

Your ninth trick will be either the ♠J or the ♦Q. In

Nonetheless it is a good idea to hold up - **but only once**.

East then plays the ♣Q which you win as West follows. Next you run four ♥ tricks, ending in dummy. You play dummy's ♠K, your sixth trick so far. It is crunch time. Do you now finesse for the ♦K or the ♠Q?

The answer is NO, you do not take either finesse. Instead you play a ♣, hoping East must take the trick. And he does. East then cashes two more ♣ tricks but then he is out of ♣s. Since he is also out of ♥s he is going to have to play either a ♠ or a ♦, either one of which will make you very happy!

The reason for holding up on the first ♣ but taking the second was to keep your options open for the endplay.

If West had not followed to the second ♣ you might not have been able to use the endplay. Instead you would have run the ♥s, and if East did not discard a ♣, you would have to guess as to which finesse to try. With the cards as shown neither would have worked.

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ K Q 9 8 4 2

♥ 8 6

♦ K 10 2

♣ 5 3

♠ J 10 5

♥ Q J 10 2

♦ Q 5 4

♣ K 8 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 6

♥ K 7 4

♦ A J 9 3

♣ A 9 7 4

♠ 7 3

♥ A 9 5 3

♦ 8 7 6

♣ Q J 10 2

West

North

East

South

2♥

Pass

2♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by East

Now it's time to play on ♦s. Do you finesse for the ♦Q? and if so, which way do you finesse?

Missing 6 ♦s to the Queen of course you should finesse. And you will finesse through North, of course, because he is the Danger Hand. So play dummy's ♦K, then play the ♦10 and let it ride.

This time North holds the ♦Q and you make an overtrick, winning 4 ♦ tricks and discarding a ♥ loser from dummy.

Another time South will hold the ♦Q and you will make the contract, but no overtrick.

Partner transfers and you naturally respond 2♠.

Partner bids the ♠ game and you pass.

East plays 4♠. South leads the ♣Q. North plays the ♣8 and your first decision is whether to hold up.

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 4

You should certainly hold up. North is the Danger hand here because if North ever gets the lead he can play a ♥ through your unprotected ♥K, possibly giving you two ♥ losers. If you take the first trick with the ♣A you open the door for North to gain entry with the ♣K which you know he has.

Next pull three rounds of trumps. Fortune smiles and they split 3-2.